

Seaglider Ballasting Checklist

Mission: _____ Seaglider ID: _____

Engineer: _____ Date: _____

Source

Paraphrased from the APL-UW IOP office-hours session on ballasting and volmax estimation and from operator service correspondence. See the [Ballasting Procedure](#) and [Trim Sheet & Re-ballasting](#) for the full explanation of each step.

1. Setup

- ☐ Trim sheet updated for every change since last ballast (sensors, batteries, VBD, fairings, wings/rudder)
- ☐ Target density for the mission written into the trim sheet – and checked if the glider just came back from service
- ☐ Lead and foam inventoried: each piece weighed, position noted, every hull face photographed
- ☐ Wings and rudder weighed; set fitted recorded
- ☐ Freshwater tank filled, deep enough to fully submerge the glider vertically ($\geq \sim 2$ m)
- ☐ Hanging scale / load cell rigged over the tank
- ☐ Suspension line ready (ties off at the rudder)
- ☐ Comms cable available and connected, with slack – no surface expression
- ☐ Antenna left disconnected and dangling free

2. Dry Weight

- ☐ Complete glider (wings, rudder, everything) weighed dry – record mass **M**